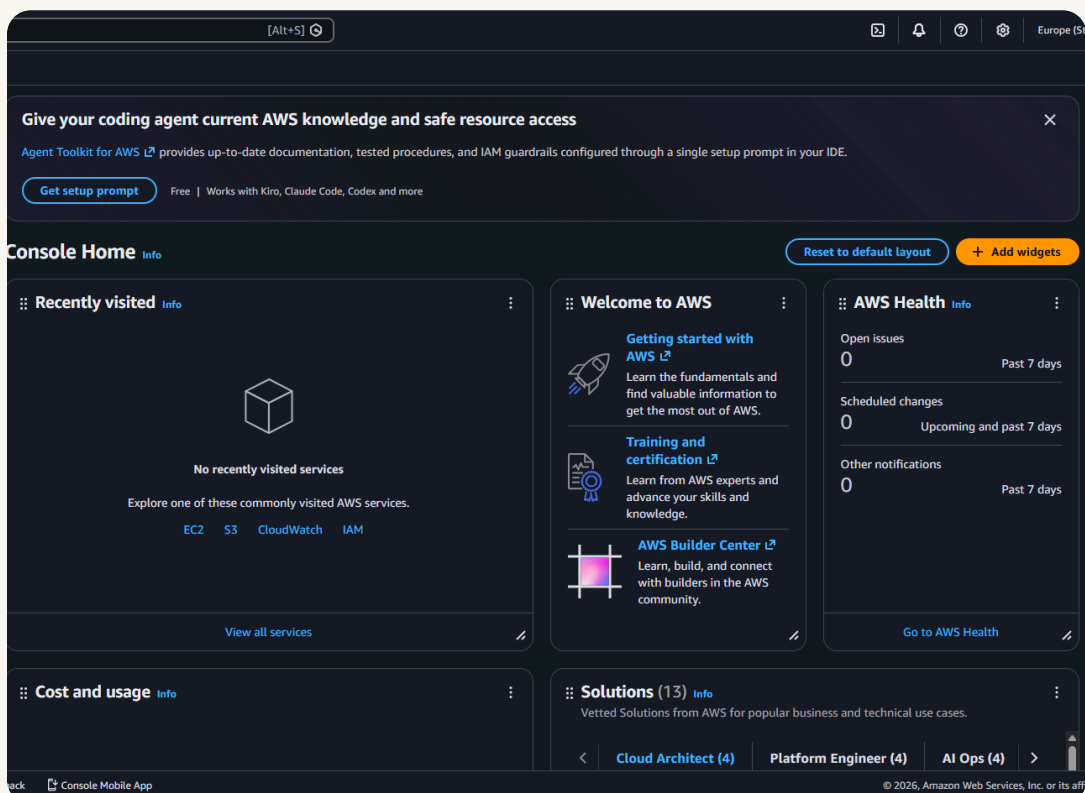




Set Up An AWS Account



Shehan Tharushe





Introducing Today's Project!

In this project, I'm going to set up my aws account

Key tools and concepts

The key tools I used include the AWS Management Console to navigate and configure services, an authenticator app to set up Multi-Factor Authentication, and the AWS Billing and Cost Management dashboard to manage billing preferences and set up alerts. Key concepts I learnt include how the root user works and why it must be protected, how MFA adds a second layer of security beyond just a password, how the AWS Free Tier works with credits and always-free services, and why billing alerts are important to avoid unexpected charges.

Challenges and wins

This project took me approximately 20 mins The most challenging part was getting my verification code for phone number



Creating My AWS Account

In this step, I'm going to create a aws account

Understanding the root user

A root user is the most powerful account in AWS. It is created when you first sign up and has full access to everything in the account. Because it is so powerful, you should protect it with a strong password and MFA, and avoid using it for everyday tasks



Setting Up Billing and Payment

In this step, I'm going to select free tier plan and enter my contact details and set a payment methods(debit card)

Why AWS requires a payment method

I learned that AWS requires a payment method because even on the Free Tier, you could accidentally exceed the free usage limits. AWS needs a card on file so they can charge you if you go over those limits. It also helps verify your identity and prevent abuse of the free tier.



Completing Account Activation

In this step, I'm going to confirm my identity and select a plan

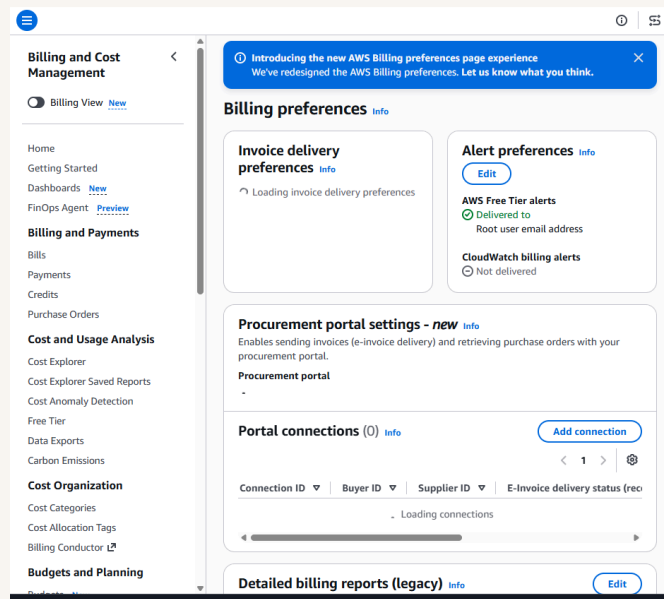
Identity verification and support plan

I verified my identity by entering my phone number and receiving a verification code from AWS to confirm I am a real person. After verification, I selected the Basic support plan, which includes access to AWS documentation, whitepapers, support forums, basic Trusted Advisor checks, and the Personal Health Dashboard. It is free for all AWS accounts but does not include access to cloud support engineers for technical help



Enabling Free Tier Alerts

In this step, I'm going to log into the console and go to profile billing and cost management and its billing preferences. I enabled free tier usage alerts



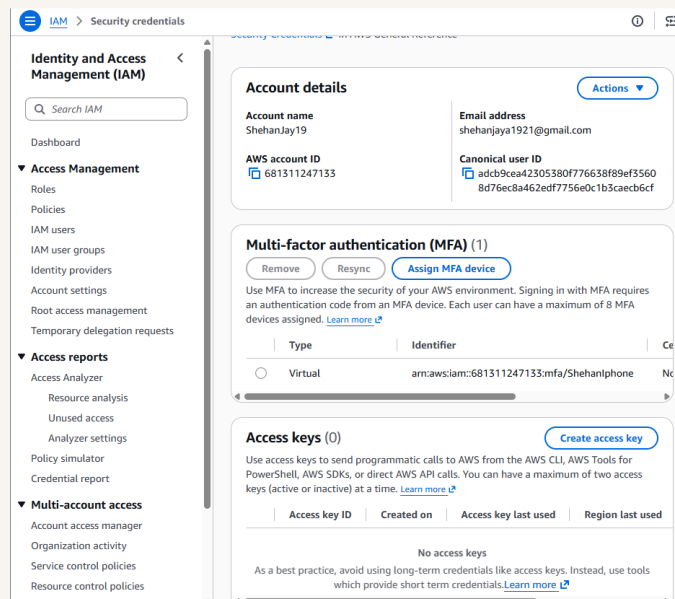
Why usage alerts matter

I set up usage alerts because if my free tier is close to finish it will alert me



Securing the Account with MFA

To enable MFA, I went to the AWS Console, clicked my account name in the top right, and selected Security Credentials, then scrolled down to the Multi-Factor Authentication section and clicked Assign MFA Device. I chose Authenticator App, scanned the QR code using my phone, and entered the two codes generated by the app to verify and activate it. The authenticator app works by generating a new 6-digit code every 30 seconds using a secret key shared between AWS and my phone during setup, so even if someone steals my password, they cannot log in without also having my phone.





nextwork.ai

The place to learn & showcase your skills

Check out nextwork.ai for more projects

